Essay Outline Builder

One copy-and-paste prompt that turns any AI chat into an essay planning teacher - it builds a clear outline with a main idea, paragraph plans and linking words, so you always know what to write next.

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Free student notes - Writing & English set

What this note is: a single shortcut, on its own, so you can save it, print it and use it in seconds. Copy the prompt on page 2 into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Muse or any other AI chat, add your topic, and you get a plan - then you write the essay yourself, in your own words.

The copy-and-paste prompt

Essay Outline Builder Works in: ChatGPT - Claude - Gemini - Muse

> Act as my essay planning teacher. Build an outline only - do NOT write the full essay for me.
> My topic: [TOPIC]
> My class / level: [CLASS / EXAM LEVEL]
> Essay type: [TYPE - for example narrative, descriptive, argumentative or expository]
> Length: about [NUMBER] words.
> Build the outline in this order:
> 1. Suggest 3 clear titles and mark the best one.
> 2. Give the thesis - the main idea of the whole essay - in one simple sentence.
> 3. Introduction plan: an opening hook, one line of background, and the thesis sentence.
> 4. Body plan: 3 or 4 paragraphs. For each one give a heading, the main point in one line, 2 supporting details or examples I can write about, and a linking word to start it (Firstly, In addition, However, Finally).
> 5. If the essay is argumentative, add one paragraph for the opposite view and how to answer it.
> 6. Conclusion plan: restate the main idea in new words and end with one strong final thought.
> 7. Finish with 8 useful words for this topic, with simple meanings, and 5 linking words I can use.
> Keep the language simple for my level. End by asking me to write my first paragraph so you can give me feedback on it.

Fill the brackets: replace [TOPIC] with your essay topic, for example "The Importance of Trees", [CLASS / EXAM LEVEL] with your class, for example "Class 9" or "Matric", and [NUMBER] with the length your teacher asked for.

How to use the outline

1. **Paste the prompt** into any AI chat, fill the brackets, and press send.
2. **Choose your title and thesis.** The thesis is your compass - every paragraph must support it.
3. **Write one paragraph at a time,** following the plan for that paragraph. Use your own examples from your life, village or school.
4. **Use the linking words** at the start of each paragraph so the essay flows instead of jumping.
5. **Ask for feedback, not a rewrite.** Paste your paragraph and type: "Check my paragraph - tell me what is good and what to fix, but do not rewrite it for me."
6. **Read the finished essay aloud.** Sentences that sound wrong when spoken usually need fixing on paper too.

> **Why an outline works:** most essays fail before they start - the writer has no plan, so ideas repeat and the ending is weak. An outline fixes the order first, so writing becomes filling a clear plan, one paragraph at a time.

What it looks like in practice

Topic: "The Importance of Trees", Class 9, about 250 words:

Title: Trees - The Silent Guardians of Life

Thesis: Trees are essential for human life because they give us clean air, food and shelter, and protect our land.

Introduction: Hook - imagine a summer day with no shade. Background - trees grow all around us. Thesis - as above.

Body 1 - Clean air (Firstly): trees absorb carbon dioxide and release oxygen; example - the trees around your school.

Body 2 - Food and shelter (In addition): fruits for people, homes for birds and animals; example - mango and guava trees in your area.

Body 3 - Protecting the land (Moreover): roots hold the soil and stop floods in the rainy season.

Conclusion: Restate the thesis in new words; final thought - planting one tree is a gift to the future.

Change the type, level or length

Add this line	What changes
This is a narrative essay - plan it as a story with a beginning, a problem and an ending.	For topics like "A Rainy Day" or "My Most Memorable Day".
Make it an argumentative essay with strong points for and against.	For topics like "Mobile Phones - Useful or Harmful?"
Make it exam-style for my board paper, about 300 words.	Matches the length and formal style board examiners expect.
Explain the outline in Urdu, but keep the essay words in English.	Understand the plan in Urdu, write the essay in English.

Use it honestly. An outline is a plan, not a finished essay. Write the essay in your own words - submitting an essay fully written by AI as your own work is cheating, and you learn nothing from it.

Check the facts too. AI outlines can include a fact that sounds right but is wrong. Check names, dates and numbers in your textbook before writing them.

More shortcuts in this set: Correct My English - Grammar Doctor - Vocabulary Builder - Letter and Application Writer.